

SHALENDRA BHAGAN



Everything's in a Name

BANGALORE When Shakespeare wrote that a rose by any other name would still smell as sweet, he hadn't predicted the plight of our modern times. For in the limitations of headline space in the media, names get shortened, sometimes drastically, and often not to the greatest pleasure of the people concerned.

Hence, when Rahul Gandhi objects to being called Yuvraj, one can see his point. Rahul, as it is,

can probably be used in newspaper by editors without much thought, but Yuvraj might confuse him with a certain cricketer. But what does one do with a name like Bookanakere Siddhalingappa Yeddyurappa? The obvious and the inevitable shortening of name happened as soon as Karnataka's new BJP chief minister took over. Yeddy's ministry, Yeddy's policies, and the life and times of Yeddy filled front

QUESTION OF FAITH: Yeddyurappa

pages. The catch is, Yeddy doesn't like being called Yeddy. In an official communiqué to media houses in Karnataka, the new chief minister has suggested that he be called BSY instead of Yeddy.

Yeddyurappa is extremely particular where his name is concerned. Last year on the advice of an astrologer he changed his originally spelt Yediyurappa to its current avatar. Understandably so, for after his infamous seven-day stint last year, the Double-D versioned leader has been reelected to the chief minister's chair, creating history for his party in south India and setting his new stint for a longer period than the last time.

However, with a wafer thin majority supported by independents in the state Assembly, his crown doesn't rest too easy on his head, yet. BSY might do to his career what Yeddy didn't. It's all a question of faith.

by Swagata Sen

No Divine Light

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM It is finally official. The hallowed Makara jyothi, the 'celestial light' that appears on the eastern horizon on the last day of the annual festival at the Sabarimala Ayyappa Temple, is man-made. For the first time ever, Minister for Temple Administration G. Sudhakaran and the famed hill shrine's supreme priest, Thantri



Sabarimala temple

Kandararu Maheswararu, have admitted that lighting the jyothi was "unofficially" done by the state-appointed Devaswom Board which runs temple. Maheswararu says it is not right to mix the man-made jyothi with the Makara nakshatra star which appears on the horizon at that precise moment.

"No one claims the light as natural. Devotees go to the temple not to witness the jyothi but to pray at the shrine," says Kummanam Rajasekharan, general secretary of the Hindu Aikya Vedi and vice-president of the state VHP. He also sees a sinister design by the non-believers to spread the lighting as a fraud. God's Own Country cannot even for a day do without a raging debate over god, faith or godmen.

by M.G. Radhakrishnan

OBJECT OF DESIRE



Big Leap

NOKIA N78
Rs 19,999

With this phone, Nokia leaps from multiple experiences on one device to actually merging experiences with one another. The N78 allows users to automatically tag location data to a picture while saving them by dates and geographical coordinates. It also fuses music, camera and the Internet, letting users generate content right from their palms. With its 2.4-inch screen, it packs WLAN, HSPDA and a 3.2 MP camera with Carl Zeiss optics. The device comes pre-loaded with maps of eight cities with location of bars, cafés, restaurants, hotels and more. The bluetooth stereo headphones offer 3-D sound.